

1. A population of a rare species of toad is being studied.

The number of toads, N , in the population, t years after the start of the study, is modelled by the equation

$$N = \frac{900e^{0.12t}}{2e^{0.12t} + 1} \quad t \geq 0, t \in \mathbb{R}$$

According to this model,

- (a) calculate the number of toads in the population at the start of the study, (1)
- (b) find the value of t when there are 420 toads in the population, giving your answer to 2 decimal places. (4)
- (c) Explain why, according to this model, the number of toads in the population can never reach 500 (1)